

The 30-Day ASVAB Study Plan

A real schedule you can keep. Built around the 4 subtests that decide whether you qualify, and the score bumps that get you the job you actually want.

Start here: only 4 subtests decide if you qualify

The ASVAB has 9 subtests. Only 4 of them feed your **AFQT**, the percentile that decides whether you get in at all:

- **AR** Arithmetic Reasoning (math word problems)
- **WK** Word Knowledge (vocabulary)
- **PC** Paragraph Comprehension (short reading passages)
- **MK** Mathematics Knowledge (algebra and geometry)

The formula is **AFQT raw = 2(WK + PC) + AR + MK**. Verbal counts twice. That means every point you raise on Word Knowledge or Paragraph Comprehension is worth double on your AFQT.

Spend 80% of week 1 on WK, PC, and AR. If you only have 30 minutes a day, do not study General Science, Auto & Shop, or Electronics in your first two weeks. They feed line scores for specific jobs, not the floor that decides if any branch will take you.

BRANCH MINIMUMS (DIPLOMA)

BRANCH	DIPLOMA MINIMUM	GED MINIMUM	NOTES
Army	31	50	Future Soldier Prep Course can cover 21–30
Marines	32	50	Biggest diploma/GED gap. No prep program.
Navy	35	50 + 15 college credits	DEP Enrichment helps 28–30
Air Force	36	65	Space Force shares the same standards
Coast Guard	40	50 + 15 college credits	Highest floor of any branch

Source: officialasvab.com (April 2026), branch enlistment policies. Re-verify with your recruiter — these change.

The 30-minute daily routine

This is the schedule that beats 90 minutes of unfocused review:

MINUTES	BLOCK	WHAT YOU ACTUALLY DO
0–5	Vocab warmup	10 Word Knowledge flashcards from yesterday's pile. Drop ones you got right twice.
5–15	Subtest drill	10 timed practice questions on today's subtest. Use a real timer. 11 seconds per WK, 36 seconds per AR.
15–22	Review wrong answers	For every miss, write one sentence on why the right answer is right. Not the rule. The reason.
22–30	New material	One new prefix or root (WK day), one new formula (AR/MK day), or one new question type (PC day).

The 11-second rule. The CAT-ASVAB gives you about 11 seconds per Word Knowledge question. If you can't answer in 11 seconds at home, you won't on test day. Train under a timer from week 1. Do not let yourself ponder.

FREE PRACTICE RESOURCES

- **Official ASVAB Practice Test** — officialasvab.com (the only free practice from DoD)
- **Quizlet ASVAB Word List** — community vocab decks, free
- **Khan Academy SAT Math** — overlap with AR and MK is ~70%
- **March2Success.com** — Army's free prep portal, includes practice tests

Skip the \$40 paid courses for now. The free stuff is enough to add 10–15 points.

More drills + retake calculator: asvabhero.com/asvab-retake-calculator

Weeks 1–2: Build the AFQT floor

Goal of the first two weeks: get your AFQT above your branch's diploma minimum, with comfortable margin. Heavy verbal load, light math.

WEEK 1 — VERBAL FOUNDATION

Day 1 WK prefixes	Day 2 WK roots	Day 3 PC main idea	Day 4 WK synonyms	Day 5 AR word problems	Day 6 Rest day. Walk. Don't open a book.	Day 7 Mini-test all 4
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WEEK 2 — ADD MATH, RAISE PACE

Day 8 MK algebra	Day 9 WK timed	Day 10 AR multi-step	Day 11 PC inference	Day 12 MK geometry	Day 13 Rest day. Long sleep, light cardio.	Day 14 Full AFQT practice test (timed)
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Day 14 is your checkpoint. Take a full AFQT practice test under real timing. Score it honestly. If you're 5+ points above your branch minimum, switch to weeks 3–4 (line scores). If you're still below, repeat week 2.

Weeks 3–4: Open the right doors

Once your AFQT clears the floor, the game changes. Now you're optimizing for line scores so the recruiter shows you the jobs you want, not the ones they need to fill.

WEEK 3 — LINE SCORES YOU ACTUALLY NEED

Find your target job. Look up its line-score formula. Drill the 1–2 subtests you're weakest in. Examples:

- **Army GT (most MOS doors):** AR + WK + PC. Same as AFQT verbal — direct overlap.
- **Air Force G (intel, admin):** WK + PC + sometimes MK
- **Navy ratings:** highly varied. Run your scores through asvabhero.com/calculator first.
- **Marines GT:** same as Army GT but the Corps weights it differently for promotions later.

Day 15 Target job line score map	Day 16 Weak subtest #1	Day 17 Weak subtest #1	Day 18 Weak subtest #2	Day 19 Mixed drill	Day 20 Rest. No screens after 9pm.	Day 21 Mini-test all 9
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WEEK 4 — TEST PREP MODE

Day 22 Full test, untimed	Day 23 Review only	Day 24 Weak subtest drill	Day 25 Full test, timed	Day 26 Light review flashcards	Day 27 Rest. Hydrate. No new material.	Day 28 Light review only
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Day 29 is the day before. Eat a real dinner. Sleep 8 hours. Lay out clothes and ID. **Day 30: test day.** Coffee but not an extra one. Arrive 30 min early. Don't talk about scores with other applicants — it spikes nerves.

If you already tested: the 1/1/6 rule

Every branch follows the same retake spacing:

ATTEMPT	WAIT TIME BEFORE RETAKE
1st retake (after first test)	1 calendar month
2nd retake	1 more calendar month
3rd retake and beyond	6 calendar months

One trap: if your score jumps **20+ points in 6 months**, DoD requires a Confirmation Test (C-Test). If you score lower on the C-Test, the lower score replaces your retake. Crammers lose both scores this way.

Aim for a gain you can hold. A real +12 from a focused 30-day plan beats a fluky +25 you can't replicate. The C-Test is the same test, same conditions. If you earned the points, you keep them.

Your next 3 moves

1. **Run your scores through the full calculator** at asvabhero.com/calculator. See every job you qualify for right now and the exact gap to your dream MOS/rate/AFSC.
2. **Block 30 minutes today**, same time tomorrow. Same time the day after. The schedule beats the willpower.
3. **Watch your inbox** over the next 2 weeks. Four more emails coming with the specific drills that move scores fastest.

QUICK LINKS

- AFQT calculator: asvabhero.com/afqt-calculator
- Score gap engine (find the +N you need for any job): asvabhero.com/calculator
- Retake date calculator: asvabhero.com/asvab-retake-calculator
- Branch-specific AFQT pages: army-, navy-, air-force-, marines-afqt-calculator

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Questions? Reply to any of our emails. We read every one.